

David Wegmann

Curriculum Vitae

PhD student, Aarhus University
DATALAB - Center for Digital Social Research
Department of Media and Journalism Studies

Aarhus University
Helsingforsgade 14
ICT-City, 8200 Aarhus, Denmark
Email: david.wegmann@cc.au.dk

Professional Career

- **2026** - Research assistant, full time DATALAB, Aarhus University, Aarhus, Denmark. Development of report for the Danish Ministry of Digital Affairs
- **2023-present** - PhD Student, full-time DATALAB, Aarhus University, Aarhus, Denmark.
- **2025** - Fellowship Digital News Dynamics Group, Weizenbaum Institute, Berlin, Germany.
- **2023** - Assistant Lecturer, part-time University of Copenhagen, Denmark.
- **2022-2023** - Research Assistant, full-time HCDS Group, IT University, Copenhagen, Denmark. Focus: online videos and data visualization.
- **2016-2019** - Video Producer, full-time Label Software Gerald Bax GmbH, Bielefeld, Germany. Focus: media relations and tutorial production.

Education

- **2019-2022** - Master of Arts, Cognition and Communication University of Copenhagen, Denmark. Thesis: *Experimental- and survey-research on online videos: The credibility effects of production value and cognitive processing fluency.*
- **2012-2019** - Bachelor of Science, Biology major and Linguistics minor University of Bielefeld, Germany.

Teaching Experience

- **2024-2025** - Lecturer: Research Design and Methods: Casestudies Aarhus University, Denmark. Part of teaching team for Master-level digital methods courses
- **2023** - Lecturer Communication Theory and Research Design University of Copenhagen, Denmark. Part of teaching team for Master-level course
- **2023-2025** - Special Paedagogical Support, voluntary activity IT University, Copenhagen, Denmark. Advising students with special needs.
- **2020** - Tutor, voluntary activity University of Copenhagen, Copenhagen, Denmark. Guidance the new year of Cognition and Communication students.

Grants and Contracts

- **2026** - Awarded contract, independent study Ministry of Digital Affairs, Denmark: *Tech Giants' Influence on Democracy, Well-Being, and Social Cohesion in Denmark.* Responsible for DATALAB's contribution as part of the consortium selected to deliver the Ministry-commissioned independent report for 2026.
- **2025** - Travel grants William Demant Fonden: Awarded funding to support international research mobility during the PhD, including a study exchange at the Weizenbaum Institute in Berlin and conference participation at CompText 2026 in Birmingham.

- **2022** - Foundational Integrity Grant

Meta Platforms Inc.: *Investigating Persuasiveness of Contextualized Disinformation Across Media*. Spearheaded the conceptualization and development of the research proposal on behalf of the HCDS Group at IT University, Copenhagen.

Publications

Bechmann, Anja, Miriam Kroman Brems, Marcus K. Olesen, Jessica G. Walter, and David Wegmann. 2025. *Data Donation as a Method for Investigating Trends and Challenges in Digital Media Landscapes at National Scale: The Danish Population's Use of YouTube as an Illustrative Case*. Nordicom, University of Gothenburg. <https://doi.org/10.48335/9789189864184>.

Wegmann, David, Emil Stevnsborg, Søren Knudsen, Luca Rossi, and Aske Mottelson. 2026. "Is Seeing Believing? Evaluating Human Sensitivity to Synthetic Video." Pre-published March 28. <https://doi.org/10.48550/arXiv.2603.13846>.